

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6 ♥

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: South

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 2
♥ Q J 10
♦ J 9 8 2
♣ 9 6 3 2

♠ A J 10 7 3

♥ 9 8 6 4

♦ K 7

♣ A K

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4

♥ A 2

♦ 10 6 4 3

♣ Q J 10 7 5

♠ K Q 8 6

♥ K 7 5 3

♦ A Q 5

♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥	Pass	4 ♠
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			

6 ♠ by North

he is now out of ♣s, just remember the bidding - he must have had 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s.

Suppose you play low on this ♥ (as North hopes you will). Dummy's ♥K will take the trick, and when another ♥ is played you will have to win it with your now bare ♥A. You will then have to play a ♦ or a ♣, giving North a ruff and sluff.

But if you take your ♥A now, then exit with your ♥2, North can win the ♥K but will still have to lose a ♥ to West.

[showcards W:CQ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣Q, West plays low and North wins the ♣A.

North pulls trumps in 2 rounds. He then takes the ♦K, ♦Q, ♦A, discarding a ♥ on the last one. Next he plays dummy's last ♣ to his ♣K.

Having done all this, North now plays a low ♥ from his hand. What do you play?

Play the ♥A.

If you followed what North was doing you will realize that he has eliminated both the ♦s and ♣s from both his hand and dummy. If it isn't clear that

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 2
 ♥ J 8 7 3 2
 ♦ A K Q
 ♣ A K

♠ 8 4 3

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 8 7 3

♣ J 8 7 4



♠ A 6
 ♥ A K 9 6 5
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ Q 10 2

♠ K Q J 9 5

♥ -

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ 9 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♦	Pass	3NT	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

[showcards N:HJ]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

South led the ♠K, won by East's ♠A. East played a small ♣ to dummy's ♣A, then led dummy's ♥J.

What do you play? ♥Q or ♥4?

Play the ♥4.

Remember that East opened 1♥, so he has 5 of them. With only 3 trumps out he has no intention of finessing. Perhaps he led the ♥J just to tempt you to cover in this situation.

If you play low he will win with one of his high ♥s and then you will have a sure ♥ winner. Along with the ♠ winner South has you will defeat the slam.

If you cover the ♥J with your ♥Q East will again win with one of his high ones. But now the position will be clear to East and he will return to dummy and play another ♥, finessing your ♥10. With no trump loser he will make the slam.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ 10 8 5 3

♠ Q J 6

♥ 10 5 4

♦ A K 3

♣ A Q 7 4



♠ K 10 7 4

♥ A 3

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ K J 9

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q J 9 8 6

♦ Q 7 5

♣ 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

That winner will take care of whatever black-suit loser he may have.

If East has a ♣ trick it is important to get it established soon. So go up with the ♠A and play a ♣ through dummy's ♣ A Q. When South tries the ♠ suit again **EAST** can win and cash his ♣K for the setting trick.

If you play low on South's ♠ play East will be forced to win the trick and he cannot profitably attack the ♣ suit from his side.

[showcards W:H2 E:HA,H3,DJ S:S3,HK,H6,D6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You decide a trump lead is called for and lead the ♥2. Your partner wins with the ♥A and plays the ♦J. South lets this go to dummy's ♦K, (but you know he has ♦Q), then plays a trump back to his ♥K, pulling the 2 outstanding trumps from West and East.

South's next play is the ♠3 from his hand. Do you play your ♠A or not?

Play the ♠A.

Even if South doesn't have the ♠K he can establish a ♠ winner just by leading twice toward the ♠ Q J.